

Deli Food Around the World

Delicatessens flourish around the world from New York to Bologna, offering an authentic glimpse into the flavors and ingredients of a country's cuisine. The wonderfully varied choices include bagels heaped with cream cheese in New York; paper-thin slices of pastrami in Montreal; springy rounds of mozzarella in Italy; and pickled herring in Denmark.

NEW YORK CITY

2nd Avenue Deli inexpensive

162 East 33rd St.; www.2ndavedeli.com

Fill up on triple-decker sandwiches of peppery pastrami and grilled salami with plenty of Russian dressing; mushroom-and-barley soup; broiled chicken livers; and potato pancakes sweetened with warm apple sauce. This time-worn deli may have moved from Second Avenue, but it still offers the same quintessential deli fare, giant portions, and no-nonsense service.

Katz's Deli moderate

205 East Houston St.; www.katzdeli.com

There are sandwiches, and then there are sandwiches. For the latter, make for Katz's Deli, the renowned Jewish deli established in 1888 on the Lower East Side. Here, pastrami comes towering on rye, and giant, steaming *knoblewurst* (garlic beef sausage) dwarfs the bread it sits on. For dessert, try an egg cream, a uniquely New York concoction of milk, chocolate syrup, and carbonated water.

Russ & Daughters moderate

179 East Houston St.; www.russanddaughters.com

This shrine to smoked fish dates back to 1914, when Joel Russ began selling salt-cured herring and salmon. Since then, Russ & Daughters has continued to satiate the smoked-fish cravings of New Yorkers with curried herring, smoked Danish salmon, and one of the finest caviar selections in Manhattan, from Siberian Osetra to salmon roe.

Eataly expensive

200 Fifth Avenue; www.eatalyny.com

This temple to Italian cuisine, with marble-topped bars and high ceilings, showcases a superb array of

Italian specialties: fat-streaked prosciutto from Parma; crumbly *reggiano* Parmesan from Emilia-Romagna; Rome-style pizzas bubbling with mozzarella and pepperoni; and Chianti and Brunello wines from Tuscany. In short: you can skip the trip to Italy — Eataly pretty much has it all.

LOS ANGELES, CA

Los Angeles, with its rich Jewish heritage, features a broad array of historic delis that serve all the traditional favorites, from matzo ball soup, brisket, and corned beef to smoked fish, chopped liver, and blueberry blintzes.

Factor's Famous Deli inexpensive

9420 West Pico Blvd.; www.factorsdeli.com

Slip into a roomy booth at this legendary deli, on Pico Boulevard since 1948, and fill up on rich deli specialties, including hot peppered beef, smoked liverwurst, and whitefish salad.

Nate and Al's inexpensive

414 North Beverly Dr.; www.nateland.com

Nate and Al's claims to be a "deli with heart" — and chances are you'll agree. It's lively and inviting, and serves homemade specials that might rival those of a Jewish grandmother. Try chicken noodle soup, corned beef and cabbage, and bursting frankfurters.

Canter's moderate

419 North Fairfax Ave.; www.cantersdeli.com

This historic Jewish deli, long a favorite with the show-business crowd, serves up hearty fare, including matzo ball soup, *challah* (braided bread), and brisket.

Langer's moderate

704 South Alvarado; www.langersdeli.com

Deli-lovers from all over LA make a pilgrimage to Langer's for its famous pastrami sandwich (No. 19 on the menu), piled high with thick-cut pastrami and Swiss cheese and served with creamy coleslaw.

MONTREAL, CANADA

Montreal's delicatessens are famous for their smoked meats, often served between huge chunks of rye bread with pickles on the side. The city is also known for its tasty bagels, which Montrealers say are even better than in New York City. You be the judge.

